

The Pricing Value Checklist

12 questions before any price decision. If you can't answer one, you've found this week's homework.

How to use it

Run it before a price increase, a new product launch, or a big discount approval. It takes 15 minutes. Every "no" is not a blocker - it's a flag telling you where your decision is running on assumptions instead of data.

A. Customer value (the starting point, always)

- [] **1. Can I state the customer's outcome unit (EUR/ha, EUR/hour, EUR/unit)?**
If you price in your unit instead of theirs, you're comparing stickers, not value.
- [] **2. Have I quantified the top 3 value drivers vs the next-best alternative?**
"Better quality" is not a number. 12 EUR/ha from one avoided application is.
- [] **3. Does the customer BELIEVE those numbers (proof factor)?**
Your lab data is not their belief. Unproven value cannot be priced.

B. Competitive context (pricing without it is guessing)

- [] **4. Do I know the real transaction prices of the 2-3 relevant competitors?**
List prices lie. Pocket prices decide.
- [] **5. Do I know which competitor moves are tactical vs structural?**
Matching a temporary promotion with a permanent price cut is self-harm.
- [] **6. Have I mapped where we have pricing power - and where we don't?**
One flat % for everything means nobody asked this question.

C. Deal economics (the math nobody runs)

- [] **7. Have I run the break-even volume for any discount on the table?**
A 6% discount at 30% margin needs +25% volume. Ask sales if they believe that.
- [] **8. Does every concession buy something specific?**
Volume, term, reference, payment days. A discount with no counterpart is a donation.
- [] **9. Is there a written expiry on every "one-time" concession?**
The customer's memory keeps the price and deletes the "one-time".

D. Execution (where good decisions die)

- [] **10. Can a sales rep repeat the value story in one sentence?**
If not, the price will be defended with discounts instead of arguments.
- [] **11. Do sales, marketing and finance know WHY this price - not just what?**
A price nobody understands is a price nobody defends.

[] **12. Have I decided the walk-away point BEFORE the negotiation?**

The walk-away math done in panic is always wrong. Do it calm.

Scoring: 10-12 yes = decide with confidence. 7-9 = close the gaps first, they're cheap now and expensive later. Below 7 = you're not pricing, you're gambling with a spreadsheet open.